SIRAH OF THE HOLY PROPHET MUHAMMAD (ﷺ)AS USWA-E-HASANA

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LIFE AND LEGACY OF THE HOLY PROPHET MUHAMMAD ﷺ

Part 01

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LEARNING OBJECTIVES

- ✓ Students will learn the concept of Uswa-e-Hasana and why the Holy Prophet (PBUH) is considered the best role model.
- ✓ Students will explore the early life of the Prophet (PBUH), including key events like his upbringing, honesty, and character.
- ✓ Students will discuss the key messages of the Prophet's final sermon and their relevance in today's world.
- ✓ Students will analyze the significance of the Prophet's migration (Hijrah) from Makkah to Madinah and its impact on the Muslim community.

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OVERVIEW

This lecture will focus on the life of the Holy Prophet Muhammad (ﷺ) as the perfect example of moral conduct, known as Uswa-e-Hasana. We will explore key events in the Prophet's life, from his early days marked by his integrity and honesty, to his prophetic mission that transformed the social and religious landscape of Arabia. The lecture will cover significant milestones such as the first revelation, the Hijrah to Madinah, and his leadership during times of peace and conflict. Special attention will be given to the Prophet's character traits his patience, humility, and mercy that serve as timeless examples for Muslims. Additionally, we will discuss his family life, his role as a statesman, and the ethical principles he established that continue to shape Islamic thought today. Through studying these aspects, students will gain a deeper understanding of how the Prophet's life provides guidance in all facets of life, making him the ultimate role model for humanity.

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LIFE OF HOLY PROPHET MUHAMMAD (ﷺ) IN MAKKAH

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LIFE OF HAZRAT MUHAMMAD (ﷺ) BEFORE PROPHET HOOD

- Hazrat Muhammad (ﷺ) was born in the month of Rabi ul Awwal in the year of Elephant, corresponding the 20th of April, 570, 52 days after the Event of Elephant.
- His father's name is Abdullah, son of Abdul Muttalib, bin Hashim bin Abd-e-Manaaf of Quraish family. His father Hazrat Abdullah died in Madinah, where he travelled when he was 25 years old. Six months after his death, his wife Hazrat Amina gave birth to a child and he was named "Muhammad".
- The name "Muhammad" was given by his grandfather Abdul Muttalib, and "Ahmad" was given by his mother.
- Prophet (ﷺ) belonged to Banu Hashim clan of Quraish tribe.

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CONTINUE……

- Back in Makkah, the Prophet's grandfather, Hazrat Abdul Mutalib the chief of Makkah took his custody; but he too passed away two years later. The Prophet (ﷺ) then went to live with his uncle, Abu Talib, who raised him like his own son.
- Abu Talib was a respected member of the Quraish tribe and a skilled tradesman, who taught the young Muhammad (ﷺ) various skills. In the beginning Hazrat Muhammad (ﷺ) worked as a shepherded for Banu Saad tribe.

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THE FIRST JOURNEY OF SYRIA

- When Prophet Muhammad (ﷺ) was 12 years old, his uncle Hazrat Abu Talib took him on a business trip to Syria. It was the first trip and it was a significant event in the life of the Prophet (ﷺ) as it exposed him to a different culture and way of life.
- During their trip, they stopped in a monastery in the city of Busra, where a monk named Buhira recognized the signs of prophethood in the young Muhammad (ﷺ) and cautioned them to not continue their journey ahead.

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SACRILEGIOUS WAR (حربِ فُجار)

- When the Prophet Muhammad(ﷺ) was 15 years old, ‘Sacrilegious war’ (Harb al-Fujjar) broke out. It was a pre-Islamic conflict.
- The war was fought between the Quraish and Qais tribes over trade and economic interests, as well as disputes over territory and resources.
- The Prophet Muhammad (ﷺ) accompanied his uncles in this war, who were members of the Quraish tribe.
- While the Prophet Muhammad (ﷺ) did participate in the war, his role was minor, primarily involving the collection of arrows thrown by the enemy and handing them over to his uncles.

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HILF AL-FUDUL (حَلفُ الفُضول)

- After the Sacrilegious war Zubair bin Abdul Muttalib proposed to revive an old agreement known as, ‘Hilf al-Fudul’.
- Hilf al-Fudul was an alliance formed in pre-Islamic Arabia between various tribes in Mecca to protect and defend the cause of the weak, the poor, and the orphan, and establish justice. Hilf al-Fudul was a peace treaty signed by the leaders of prominent tribes of Makkah.

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FIXING OF BLACK STONE (THE DISPUTE OF KA'BA)

- Later, once, when the Ka’abah was being rebuilt, the issue of fixing the black stone aroused. Everybody wanted to this prestigious task and none was willing to compromise; so much so that bloodshed was feared.
- In such a hostile situation, an elderly man (Walid bin Mughaira) suggested that anybody who entered the Ka’abah first would make the decision.
- Fortunately, it was the Holy Prophet Muhammad (ﷺ) who made a very wise decision. He laid the stone on a sheet and told the leaders of the tribes to hold the sheet from each corner and lift it up.
- When the stone reached the desired level, the Prophet Muhammad (ﷺ) picked the stone and placed it on its position.

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THE PROPHET HOOD

First Revelation:

When the Prophet (ﷺ) was nearing the age of 40, in 610 A.D, what he had seen in his dream, started to take place exactly for about six months.

He would take dates and water along and meditate in the cave of Hira. Cave Hira is in the An-Noor mountain.

He used to ponder over the God of his forefathers, especially Hazrat Ibrahim (AS), and he detested the ill practices of the Arabs.

During one of these days, which occurred at the close of the holy month of Ramzan, an angel named Jibraeel A.S. came before him and requested that he read.

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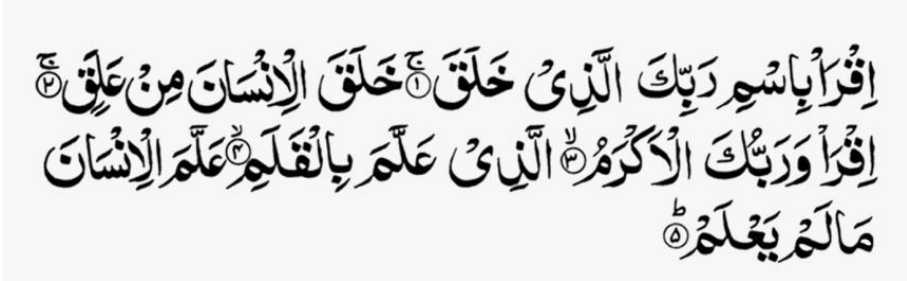
FIRST REVELATION

The Prophet (PBUH) replied that he could not read since he had no formal education. The angel then hugged him tightly and asked him again to read.

The Prophet (PBUH) again replied that he could not read.

The angel again squeezed the Prophet (PBUH) tightly and repeated his demand for the third time. The Prophet (PBUH) finally asked, what should I read?

In response, the angel recited the first 5 verses of Surah Alaq:


اقْرَأْ بِاسْمِ رَبِّكَ الَّذِي خَلَقَ ﴿١﴾ خَلَقَ الْإِنسَانَ مِنْ عَلَقٍ ﴿٢﴾
اقْرَأْ وَرَبُّكَ الْأَكْرَمُ ﴿٣﴾ الَّذِي عَلَّمَ بِالْقَلَمِ ﴿٤﴾ عَلَّمَ الْإِنسَانَ
مَا لَمْ يَعْلَمْ ﴿٥﴾

Translation:

1. Read, O Prophet, in the Name of your Lord Who created.
2. created humans from a clinging clot.
3. Read! And your Lord is the Most Generous.
4. Who taught by the pen.
5. taught humanity what they knew not.

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THE FAMILY OF MUHAMMAD ﷺ (اهل البیت)

The Marriage of Prophet Muhammad (ﷺ) and Khadija

- Khadija, the daughter of Khuwaylid, was a resident of Makkah. She also belonged to the tribe of Quraish.

Prophet Muhammad's Children:

- The family of Prophet Muhammad also includes his seven children. All of them except for one were from his first wife, Khadija. His children included three sons **Qasim**, **Abdullah** and **Ibrahim**, all of whom died in early childhood. He also had four daughters, namely:

- **Hazrat Zainab:** She was Muhammad's eldest daughter from Khadija. She converted to Islam as soon as Muhammad revealed himself as the Prophet.
- **Hazrat Ruqaiyyah:** She became a Muslim at the same time as her mother.
- **Hazrat Umm Kulthum:** She was Muhammad and Khadija's first daughter born after they moved to Makkah. Shortly after her mother died, she converted to Islam.
- **Hazrat Fatimah:** She was Muhammad's youngest daughter and the mother of his grandsons, Hussain and Hassan. She spent most of her time praying and is considered a role model for all Muslims.

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OPPOSITION AND PERSECUTION BY THE QURAISH

- During his early years, the Prophet Muhammad (ﷺ) had to face severe persecution and opposition from the Quriash, some examples are mentioned below:
- When the Holy Prophet Muhammad (ﷺ) first called them to Islam at the mount of Safa, he was ridiculed and made fun of.
- The Makkans wrote poems to ridicule the Prophet (ﷺ) and called him a magician.
- Once, when the Prophet Muhammad (ﷺ) was praying a Quraish threw the intestines of a camel on his back while he was prostrating.
- Abu Lahab told his sons to divorce their wives who were the Prophet Muhammad's Daughters, just to add to his worries.
- When both of the Prophet Muhammad's sons passed away in infancy, the Quraish called him "abtar" – he who has no male descendants.
- They also offered him bribes like making him king or marrying him to the prettiest girl so that he would stop preaching Islam.

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MIGRATION TO HABSHA 5TH NABAVI (MIGRATION TO ABYSSINIA)

The early Muslim community in Makkah faced relentless persecution from the Quraish tribe, prompting the Prophet Muhammad ﷺ to seek a solution for his followers' safety and well-being.

15 Muslims went to Abyssinia on the instructions of the Prophet Muhammadﷺ 's and that was the Islam's first migration. A group of eleven men and four women secretly left for Abyssinia, these included Hazrat Usman (RA) and his wife Hazrat Ruqaiya (RA), daughter of the Prophet (ﷺ).

The second group followed another group of 70 men including Hazrat Jafar (RA) son of Abu Talib.

In front of Najashi (also known as Negus), the ruler of Abyssinia, the Muslims were represented by Jafar ibn Abi Talib.

Hearing about Muslim migration, Quraish sent a mission to Abyssinia. This envoy told Abyssinia's monarch about Muslims. Saddened by Najashi's refusal, Quraishi returned to Makkah.

It was occurred in 5th year prophetic year.

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Social Boycott of Banu Hashim

- In the 7th year of the Holy Prophet's mission , all the chiefs of Makkah drafted an agreement against the Hashimites. Under the agreement, total boycott of Hashimites was proclaimed, nobody was entitled to have any relation with them including the sale of food stuff until the Holy Prophet (ﷺ) was executed or handed over to Quraish. The agreement was signed by all the leaders of Makkah. It was hung on the Kabah, so that no one could dare to violate it.
- For 3 whole years, all the people of Banu Hashim except Abu Jahal were forced to leave in a secluded valley known as 'Sha'ab of Abu Talib' in the outskirts of Makkah. Sha'ab means valley.
- A total boycott, social and economic was done with them so much so that they had to survive on boiled leather and wild leaves for food.
- Allah revealed to the Holy Prophet (ﷺ) that the earthworms had eaten every thing that had been written in the pact with the exception of the name of Allah. When the Quraish leaders viewed the paper, they had signed and found this to be true, they ended the boycott.

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THE YEAR OF GRIEF

- In the 10th year of Holy Prophet's mission, In between such persecutions, Prophet's wife Hazrat Khadija (RA) and his uncle Hazrat Abu Talib passed away. This was a huge loss for the Prophet Muhammad (ﷺ) because both of them had been a source of immense support for the Prophet Muhammad (ﷺ). It was because of this tragic loss that the Prophet Muhammad (ﷺ) called this Year "THE YEAR OF GRIEF".

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Journey to Ta'if

- While the Prophet (PBUH) was just recovering from this loss, he decided to focus on the expansion of Islam. Therefore, he travelled to the valley of Taif along with his adopted son, Zaid Bin Haris (RA), to preach Islam.
- Eventually, the Prophet (PBUH) took refuge in a nearby orchard and when an angel asked about punishing the people, the Prophet (PBUH) refused recognizing their influence and in fact prayed for them.
- After this event he realized that he needed another place to preach Islam as it was certainly not acceptable to the people of Taif or Makkah.

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ASCENSION TO THE SKY (معراج)

Al' Isra (الاسراء): the journey form Masjid e Haram (Makkah) to Masjid e Aqsa (Jerusalem).

Al' Mairaj (المعراج): the journey from Masjid e Aqsa to Sidra-tul-Muntaha (the Prophet's PBUH ascension to the heavens).

In the meantime, the Great Allah called His beloved Prophet (ﷺ) to His nearness and made him travel out of this material world into the heavenly world (عالم سموات) Paradise and Hell (جنت، جہنم).Allah's throne (عرش) and showed Sidrah tul Muntaha (سدرة المنتهى) and the plank and pen (لوح محفوظ) to him. Showed him the unseen and brightness of His brilliance, luster, and person and attributes. This event is called. Ascension to sky or Mairaj. This was also intended to give him the consolation of heart. He was also given all sorts of knowledge and expertise. Moreover, Namaz was also made obligatory during this ascension. It was also meant to tell all men, Jinn, and angels as to who was the most beloved of all creatures to Allah and what was the position of the last of the prophets in the eye of Allah.

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MIGRATION (TO MADINAH)

Prophet Muhammad received divine permission to migrate to Medina for safety and growth.

Muslims prepared to leave Makkah, leaving behind their homes and possessions. Prophet Muhammad sent companions to Madinah fearing a bloodbath. 100 households left Makkah. Madinah greets Muhajirs (migrants).

- Prophet Muhammadﷺ and Abu Bakr migrated secretly to Medina, followed by other believers. The Prophet hid on Mount Thawr near Makkah. After 13 days, the Prophet arrived at Madinah on 16 Rabiul Awwal.
- In Medina, they were warmly welcomed, and the community flourished under Prophet Muhammad's leadership.
- The migration marked a pivotal moment in Islamic history, establishing the first Islamic state and spreading Islam beyond Makkah.

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LIFE OF HOLY PROPHET (ﷺ) IN MADINAH

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MAJOR EVENTS IN MADINAH

- The Brotherhood (Settlement of Muhajireen and Ansar)
- The Charter of Madina
- Battle of Badar
- Battle of Uhad
- Treaty of Hudaibiya
- Conquest of Makkah
- Sermon of the Holy Prophet

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IMPORTANT EVENTS OF LIFE HOLY PROPHET IN MADINA

1 Hijrih Brotherhood

- The makkans had left their families and belongings in Makkah and now they needed financial support.
- Holy Prophet (ﷺ) arranged the brotherhood between the immigrants of Makkah and Madina which is called Mowakhat.
- The Ansar offered endless support to the emigrants and tried their best to facilitate them.
- The emigrants, on the other hand, did not become a burden on the Ansar and soon started living independently.

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THE MEDINA CHARTER

The **Medina Charter**, also known as the **Constitution of Medina**, is one of the most remarkable documents in the history of governance and Islamic civilization. It was drafted by **Prophet Muhammad (ﷺ)** in the year 622 CE, soon after his migration (Hijrah) from Makkah to **Yathrib**, which later became known as **Medina**. The Charter was designed to bring peace among the diverse tribes and religious communities of the city and to lay the foundation for a just and united society. It is considered by many historians and scholars as one of the first written constitutions in the world.

When the Prophet (ﷺ) arrived in Medina, the city was a melting pot of different communities. It included the two major Arab tribes, **Aws** and **Khazraj**, several **Jewish tribes** such as **Banu Qaynuqa, Banu Nadir**, and **Banu Qurayza**, as well as both Muslims and pagans. These groups had a long history of mutual conflict, blood feuds, and a lack of centralized authority. The Prophet (ﷺ) aimed to unite these groups under a single community while respecting their religious and cultural differences. The result was the Medina Charter **(**a political and social agreement that defined the responsibilities and rights of all residents of Medina.**)**

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The **Medina Charter** contained around **47 to 52 clauses**, covering religion, justice, security, and cooperation. It recognized Muslims as a single **Ummah**, transcending tribal divisions, and granted **religious freedom** to non-Muslims, especially Jews, declaring them part of the community with their own faith. The Charter also ensured **mutual defense**, **justice through consultation**, and appointed **Prophet Muhammad (ﷺ)** as the final authority. It protected life and property, discouraged revenge, and introduced a system of **blood money** to end tribal violence.

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02 HIJRI BATTLE OF BADAR

- The most significant battle of Badar fought in the same year on the 17th Ramadan, 2 Hijrih.
- In Makkah, the Holy Prophet had to contend with only one enemy, the Quraish, who eventually forced him to migrate from the city. However, in Medina, he faced three adversaries: the Quraish, the Jewish tribes who repeatedly violated treaties with the Muslims, and the Hypocrites, or Munafiqin, who outwardly professed Islam but worked against the Muslim community.
- Allah had already permitted Muslims to engage in jihad. When news reached the Holy Prophet that the Quraish were advancing towards Medina to attack, he called upon the Muslims to defend their city.
- The two tribes clashed at Badar, a village located eighty miles from Medina. The Quraish numbered in the thousands and were well-equipped, even bringing a vast quantity of food with them. On the Muslim side, there was a shortage of water and they are 313.

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CONTINUE...

- As the battle commenced, the Holy Prophet prostrated himself before Allah and sought His assistance. Suddenly, a torrential rainfall occurred, providing the Muslims with much-needed water. With divine intervention, Allah granted victory to the Muslims.
- Seventy of the Quraish were killed, and seventy were taken as prisoners. In contrast, the Muslims suffered minimal losses, with only fourteen casualties.

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03 HIJRI BATTLE OF UHAD

- Battle of Uhad was the second battle between Muslims and Quraish. The Quraish wanted to get revenge because they had lost a previous battle called the Battle of Badar.
- The battle of Uhud took place on 7th Shawaal 3 Hijrih.
- The army of disbelievers was three thousand while Muslims were thousand.
- Adbullah bin Ubayy and three hundred of his followers deserted the muslims and returned to Madina. The Muslim army was left with only seven hundred soldiers.
- At first, the Muslims had a good position on a mountain called Uhud, which gave them an advantage.
- The battle started well for the Muslims. They fought back and pushed the Quraish fighters away. But some Muslim archers left their positions to collect things (Mal e Ghanimat) from the enemy, which was against the plan.

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- Taking advantage of this mistake, the Quraish cavalry, led by a skilled commander named Khalid ibn al-Walid, attacked the Muslim side from behind. This caused confusion and made it harder for the Muslims to defend themselves.
- Even though the Muslims showed bravery and fought hard, they couldn't keep their strong position. None of the armies could win the battle of Uhad.
- The Prophet Muhammad (ﷺ) got injured, and twenty-two or twenty-three disbelievers were killed and seventy Muslims martyred in this battle.
- However, Muslims had to suffer a great loss because of disobedience of the Holy Prophet (ﷺ) instruction.
- The Battle of Uhud was a tough fight for the Muslims, the Muslims learned important lessons about discipline and following plans in future battles.

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5 HIJRIH BATTLE OF KHANDAQ (TRENCH)

- Battle of Khandaq (trench) or Battle of Ahzaab (groups) took place in Zil-Qa`dah 5 A.H. All the groups (Quraish of Makkah, the Jews and Munafiqeen (Hypocrites)) gathered their forces and decided to attack Madina.
- An army of ten thousand fierce warriors, which later doubled, marched towards Madina to destroy the Muslims.
- Hazrat Salmaan Farsi (RA) suggested to make trenches around the city of Madina. Then Prophet Muhammad (ﷺ) together with three thousand companions prepared to dig these trenches which was 5 meters wide and 5 meters deep and about 8 kilometers long. It took the 6 days to complete digging it.
- The disbelievers placed Madinah under siege for almost fifteen days. The Banu Quraizah, whom the Muslims feared, sided with the disbelievers and this increased their number.
- Holy Prophet (ﷺ) missed his four prayers (Salaah) on one day when disbelievers began throwing stones and shooting arrows at the muslims.
- Allah sent a hurricane against the disbelievers that it uprooted their tents from the ground and overturned their pots that were over the blazing fire.

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6 HIJRIH TREATY OF HUDAYBIYYAH

The Treaty of Hudaybiyyah (Ṣulḥ al-Ḥudaybiyyah) was a significant peace agreement between Prophet Muhammad (ﷺ) and the Quraish tribe of Makkah in 628 CE (6 AH). This was written by Hazrat Ali bin Abi Talib. It was signed near the place of Hudaybiyyah after negotiations when the Prophet Muhammad (ﷺ) and 1,400 Muslims arrived in a peaceful state to perform Umrah, following a dream he had seen.

The Quraish denied them entry into Makkah, leading to the treaty.

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Key terms included:

- Muslims would return to Madinah that year and come for pilgrimage the next year; a 10-year truce would be upheld; and mutual pacts with other tribes were allowed. Also, if someone from Makkah joined the Muslims, they would be returned, but not vice versa.
- Though seemingly unfavorable to Muslims at first, the treaty proved highly beneficial. It reduced hostilities, allowed for peaceful spread of Islam, and showed the Prophet (ﷺ) as a recognized leader. Many accepted Islam during this time, and the Quraish's indirect recognition of the Muslim state marked a turning point in Islamic history.
- The treaty taught lessons of patience, diplomacy, and long-term strategy, and is seen as a key step in the eventual conquest of Makkah.

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CONQUEST OF MAKKAH

On the 10th of Ramadan, 8 AH, the Messenger of Allah (S.A.W.), along with his 10,000 companions, which was the largest Muslim force ever assembled as of that time, went on their journey to Makkah.

The Conquest of Makkah happened in 630 CE (8 AH) when Prophet Muhammad (ﷺ) and his followers entered Makkah without fighting, after years of conflict with the Quraish tribe. Instead of seeking revenge, the Prophet showed kindness and forgave the people of Makkah. He gave everyone safety, showing his mercy. The idols around the Kaaba, which people had worshipped for years, were removed, and the Kaaba was returned to being a place to worship one God. This moment ended idol worship in Makkah, and many people in the city accepted Islam because they were impressed by the Prophet's compassion. It was a turning point in the spread of Islam.

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10 HIJRIH FAREWELL PILGRIMAGE

- Holy Prophet (ﷺ) left for Hajj on the 25th Zul-Qa'dah 10 A.H. and more than one hundred thousand companions joined him.
- Holy Prophet (ﷺ) tied ihram from Zul-Hulaifah, six miles from Madinah. They, reached Makkah on Saturday, 4th Zil-Hijjah.
- On the 9th Zul-Hijjah after reaching Arafaat, Prophet (ﷺ) delivered a very inspiring Khutbah (Speech) which was full of advice and wisdom. After performing Hajj, Prophet (ﷺ) remained in Makkah for few days and thereafter returned to Madinah.

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SALIENT FEATURES OF THE LAST SERMON

- **Sanctity of Human Life:** Life and property are sacred and must not be violated unjustly.
- **End of Usury (Interest):** All forms of **riba (interest)** are abolished, beginning with the Prophet's own family's dues.
- **Abolition of Blood Revenge:** All claims of **blood vengeance** from the pre-Islamic era were declared void.
- **Unity of the Muslim Ummah:** All Muslims are part of one **brotherhood**, regardless of tribe or race.
- **Equality of All Humans:** No Arab is superior to a non-Arab, and no white person is superior to a black person, except in **piety (taqwa)**.
- **Rights of Women:** Women have **rights** over men just as men have rights over women; men must treat women kindly.
- **Trust and Responsibility:** Trusts must be returned to their rightful owners; **accountability** is emphasized.

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- **Brotherhood and Non-Violence:** Do not harm others, so you may not be harmed; believers are **brothers** to one another.
- **Finality of Prophethood:** The Prophet (ﷺ) declared, “There is no prophet after me, and no new religion.”
- **Holding Fast to Qur’an and Sunnah:** He urged Muslims to **follow the Qur’an and Sunnah** to remain guided.
- **Justice for All:** Injustice of any kind, including against non-Muslims, is forbidden.
- **Condemnation of Racism and Tribalism:** Superiority lies only in **piety and righteousness**, not in lineage or race.
- **Clear Conveyance of Message:** The Prophet (ﷺ) confirmed that he had **completed the delivery of the message**.
- **Inheritance Rights:** Follow the Islamic rules of **inheritance** as outlined in the Qur’an.

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Holy Prophet's Last Sickness and Demise
11 Hijrih

On 28th Safar 11 A.H. Holy Prophet (ﷺ) visited Jannat ul Baqee where he made dua for the inmates of the graves. After returning home, Afterwards, he got a fever that lasted 13 days. In this condition Holy Prophet (ﷺ) left this world. On Monday the 12th Rabi-ul-Awwal, after the Zuhr Salaah, Holy Prophet (ﷺ) left this worldly abode and went to meet his creator, Allah. His age at the time of death was 63 years. He was buried in the apartment of Hazrat Aisha.

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THANK YOU

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